



MOTHER DAIRY, DELHI

FREEZE FRAME

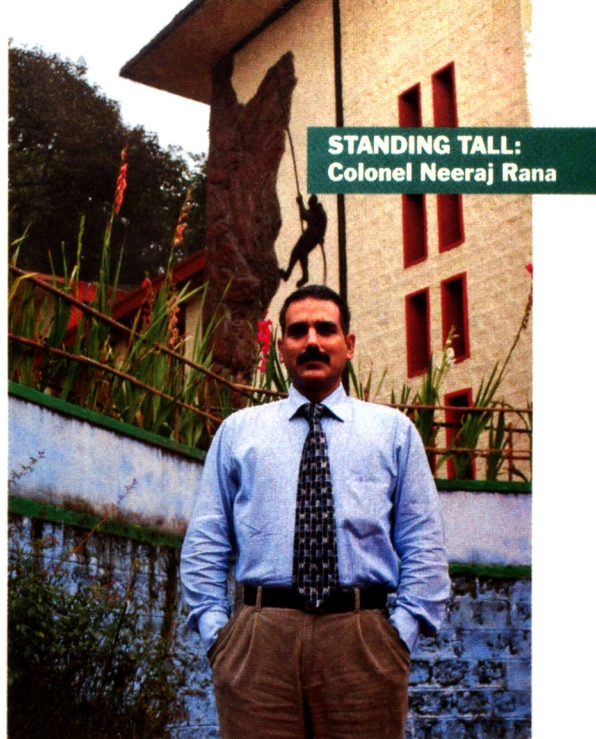
Walk around the neighbourhood at 7 a.m. and you'll see a queue of people armed with tin cans and tokens. It's your early morning friendly neighbourhood rendezvous at Mother Dairy. A National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) endeavour, it's more than just the single largest brand of milk in India and Asia, marketing three million litres of milk and other dairy products, with an annual turnover of Rs 2,750 crore in 2006-07. It also represents a sense of community. Mother Dairy was set up during the Operation Flood programme in 1974. "The shortage of milk was filled by dairy cooperatives in villages. Farmers provided their surplus to milk unions, who supplied it to urban markets," says Paul Thachil, CEO, Mother Dairy Fruit and Vegetable Private Limited. Milk flows in from Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh, Rajasthan and Gujarat. Millions of farmers can access urban markets and are given close to 75 per cent of the maximum retail price. With changing lifestyles, the demand for Dhara range of edible oils, Safal frozen fruits and vegetables, butter, and Ultra High Temperature milk has increased. To cater to the health conscious, probiotic lassi, curd and milk have been introduced under the brands B-Activ and Nutrifi. It introduced ice creams in 1996 and plans to expand its portfolio in the next five years. **by Purvi Malhotra**

"Twenty years ago if we'd have asked people to buy frozen peas, they would have laughed at us." PAUL THACHIL, CEO, MOTHER DAIRY FRUIT AND VEGETABLE PRIVATE LIMITED



THE HOLY COW:
Paul Thachil

RAVI S SAHANI



STANDING TALL:
Colonel Neeraj Rana

NEELAM GHIMRE

HIMALAYAN MOUNTAINEERING
INSTITUTE, DARJEELING

VERTICAL LIMITS

Fifty-four years ago, the then prime minister Jawaharlal Nehru decided to play genie and asked Tenzing Norgay what he wished to do after his memorable ascent to the summit of Mount Everest. Tenzing expressed his desire to set up a mountaineering institute in his hometown, Darjeeling, to teach others the craft. The wish was instantly granted and the Himalayan Mountaineering Institute (HMI), which owes its existence to the mountaineering icon, was born. Today, the institute which churns out 1,600 trainees in a calendar year—30 of the visually handicapped are trained in a mountaineering course—has acquired a reputation of being one of the finest in the world. "We have no competition. There is no institute with the live training facilities we offer," says its Principal, Colonel Neeraj Rana. Part of the reason is that the main training ground which resounds with the clink of carabiners and the tapping of ice picks, is located at over 15,000 ft in the Kanchenjunga National Park in Sikkim. Each year, aspiring climbers and veterans from over 100 countries including the US, Australia, the UK, France and even Bosnia and Herzegovina, throng the world's ice station to learn rock, snow and ice craft.

by Sandeep Unnithan

ON TOP OF THE WORLD Kushang Sherpa, an HMI instructor, holds the world record for climbing Mt. Everest from all four directions.